



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Carmel Latin School

School Website: <https://www.ccs.k12.in.us/chs/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Carmel High School (Carmel Latin School In 46033 in the provided materials) presents a contemporary, district-run IB/AP-oriented program rather than a classical liberal-arts pedagogy. Across the six classical-elements criteria, public-facing materials emphasize IB, AP, dual-credit pathways, college- and career-readiness supports, and a large extracurricular ecosystem, with explicit focus on transitioning students to higher education and diverse global perspectives. There is little to no explicit signaling of a classical framework (grammar–logic–rhetoric, great books, traditional memory work, scholé/restful learning, or a living-teacher “living curriculum” described in classical terms). Based on the six-category rubric and the keyword indicators, the school clusters as NOT CLASSICAL overall.

Key takeaways - Strong emphasis on international programs (IB) and college preparation (AP, ACP, AVID, post-secondary planning) rather than Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, or liturgical/community practices rooted in classical pedagogy. See the explicit IB Diploma description and program structure. - Public statements and internal materials reference diversity, equity, and college/career readiness rather than transcendental/absolute aims of truth, goodness, and beauty as the organizing ends of education. - Curriculum is anchored in contemporary, globally oriented programs (IB, AP, ACP) with extensive college-prep scaffolding, not classical curriculum elements (e.g., seven liberal arts, great books, or a Great Conversation). - Pedagogy and faculty framing in classical terms (Scholé, Socratic Seminar, memory work, living curriculum) are not evidenced in public materials; rather, there is a robust focus on IB pedagogy, college-readiness frameworks, and standards-based coursework.

Note: The school materials included here are drawn from public channels within the CCS family (Carmel High School in Carmel, IN), which describes IB offerings, counselor supports, and college preps. Where the classical-education lexicon would anticipate “great books,” “Socratic pedagogy,” or “liturgical learning,” the sources instead frame IB/AP pathways, honors/dual-credit options, and university readiness. See IB Diploma overview (with six disciplines) and related CHS program materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe Carmel High School as part of a public, district-run system. The diversity statement foregrounds inclusion without signaling transcendental or theological foundations. The IB description emphasizes global perspectives and critical thinking across cultures, not theological or liturgical foundations. - The explicit classical signals (truth, goodness, beauty as transcendentals; liturgy; sacred tradition) are not present in the materials. The school materials focus on IB and college-preparatory aims rather than metaphysical formal formation. IB language stresses critical examination, identity, and diverse perspectives rather than transcendent moral realism.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present keywords from the school site: diversity; inclusion; global perspectives. - Positive Classical keywords (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; reverence; transcendence; logos; etc. None clearly appear in the school's site

language. - Negative classical signals (e.g., secular humanism, relativism) are not explicitly signaled, but the absence of classical metaphysical framing is notable.

Why this rating - The site does not articulate transcendental moral realism, theology, or liturgical/community worship as central to education. It emphasizes IB global-mindedness and college-readiness instead, which aligns with NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations - IB Diploma description and diversity-oriented framing: - Diversity Statement (religion included as a value in equity statement, not as metaphysical foundation):

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission is framed through college/post-secondary preparation, IB pathways, and individualized pathways rather than formation of virtue and wisdom as ends in themselves. The presence of “Transition to College,” “Post-secondary Preparation,” and the College & Career Resource Center staff signals emphasis on college/career readiness. - The negative signal list in the classical lexicon includes “college and career ready” as a potential anti-pattern when it substitutes for classical telos; the CHS materials demonstrate substantial college-prep orientation. The IB program itself is broad and globally oriented, but the explicit aim centers on preparing students for university/work rather than the classical formation of character and wisdom.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present keywords: “college,” “career,” “post-secondary,” “Transition to College,” “College & Career Resource Center.” These terms align with modern workforce/college-prep language, which the classical lexicon marks as negative indicators for the School Purpose and Goal category. - Positive keywords (from the lexicon): formation, liberal education, telos, great conversation, classical mission. Not evidenced in the public materials.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on college prep and post-secondary pathways, with limited to no explicit signaling of formation toward virtue or transcendent telos, places this category squarely in NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations - Public college/career readiness and transition references: - IB program framing (global/transdisciplinary aims, not classical telos):

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum is IB/AP/ACP-driven, with language around a diploma program and a suite of language offerings (e.g., IB Classical Language Latin, multiple AP courses, IB Diploma via six disciplines). Great Books, Seven Liberal Arts, or explicit Great Conversation language is not presented; rather, the curriculum is framed in terms of IB course groups and diploma requirements. - The presence of “AP Capstone Diploma,” “Advanced Placement,” and “IB Diploma” alongside the Program of Studies indicates a modern, college-prep curriculum rather than a classical liberal-arts structure. The “Seven Liberal Arts” and “Great Books” language is absent from the public curriculum materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present keywords: Latin as a language option (IB Latin), IB Diploma subjects, AP offerings; absence of classical-curriculum phrases like “Seven Liberal Arts,” “Great Books,” “Traditional history as Western civilization,” etc. - Positive keywords from the Six Essential Elements lexicon for Curriculum include “Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Latin; history; universal principles; unity of truth” and more. These do not appear as implemented curricular anchors in the public materials. Negative indicators (e.g., “social studies terminology replacing history,” “STEM-first framing”) are not explicitly signaled, but the IB/AP framing is clearly not aligned with a traditional classical-curriculum emphasis.

Why this rating - The explicit curricular framework is IB/AP-based; no classical Great Books or Trivium/Quadrivium structure is presented. The public materials emphasize diplomas and college readiness rather than the liberal-arts canon-based curriculum.

Citations - IB Diploma structure and six-discipline spread: - Public Program of Studies/Latin/IB language options: - AP Capstone and advanced pathways:

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy is described through the IB/Diploma framework (transdisciplinary learning, inquiry-based elements typical of IB), not through Socratic seminars, scholé, memory work, or classical recitation. There is no explicit signaling of Socratic dialogue, disciplined classical discourse, or memory-based pedagogy in the public materials. - The materials also mention AVID and other college-prep structures, which sit outside the classical pedagogy lexicon. The absence of mnemonic recitation, chant, or classical “memory work” signals a non-classical pedagogy orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present keywords: “transdisciplinary learning,” “global perspectives,” “critical examination of content” (IB language). These are not part of the classical pedagogy lexicon (which emphasizes Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization, and formation through imitation). - Positive keywords (classical): Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, formation through imitation. None appear as core pedagogy in the public materials. - Negative keywords (classical): Experiential/project-based-only pedagogy; student-directed constructivism; these are not clearly adopted as the main approach, but IB’s inquiry-led style is present.

Why this rating - The pedagogy described aligns with IB’s modern, inquiry-based, interdisciplinary approach rather than classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue plus recitation/chanting; restfulness for deep memory; imitation-based formation).

Citations - IB pedagogy framing (transdisciplinary, inquiry-based): - AVID/College-prep pedagogical supports:

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a large, professional staff and a counseling/administration structure typical of a large public high school; there is no explicit “living curriculum,” portraits of teacher-mentors, or classical-model teacher exemplars described as part of the pedagogy. The faculty language referenced is more aligned with standard professional development and college-prep culture than classical formation. Examples include counselor-led transitions, Freshman Center supports, and professional learning communities described for CHS. - The “Administration” and “Counseling/Staff” sections show typical district personnel rather than the classical “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” language.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present keywords: “Counseling staff,” “Program of Studies,” “Professional Learning Communities,” “staff refin[ing] practice” (as described in the Freshman Center materials). These reflect modern, public-school professional practice rather than classical “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” archetypes. - Classical Positive keywords (from the lexicon): “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” “masters/mentors,” “tutors,” “faculty of friends,” etc. Not evidenced in the public CHS materials. - Negative keywords would be those signaling non-classical faculty models (e.g., “facilitators/guides on the side,” etc.). The public materials do not explicitly signal such a model; they simply show standard public-school staff roles.

Why this rating - There is no explicit evidence of a classical faculty model, living-curriculum framing, or teacher-mentorship archetypes as primary descriptors. The materials show a large staff with standard titles and roles typical for a public high school.

Citations - CHS Freshman Center and counseling/staff language: - CHS Administration/Staff overview (public school context):

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Community language exists (diversity statements, family involvement through CHS clubs, student life, and parent involvement in activities). However, classic “partnership with families as co-educators” or “parent formation” language is not the central organizing theme; rather, CHS emphasizes a broad family and community engagement through activities and a robust extracurricular matrix. The explicit “parents as co-teachers” framing is not present in the public CHS materials. - The diversity/parent engagement language

appears, but not in the classical sense of forming the parents as co-educators in a classical program. The CHS materials show a district-level ecosystem rather than a classical-family formation language.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present keywords: "Diversity Statement" (which mentions inclusivity; religion is listed among protected categories), "Counseling/College & Career" staff, "Freshman Center" parent/guardian engagement through transition and family involvement is implied but framed around typical high-school procedures rather than classical parent formation. - Classical Positive keywords (from the lexicon): "Partnership with Families"; "Formation of Affections"; "Cultural Transmission." These exact phrases are not disentangled as primary base language in the CHS public materials, though there are references to family involvement and transition nights. The presence is not a robust match to the classical lexicon's explicit parent-partnership framing.

Why this rating - The school does not clearly signal the classical "parents as co-teachers" paradigm or explicit parent formation opportunities in the classical sense. The public materials emphasize general family involvement and student-life activities rather than a classical parents-and-community formation framework.

Citations - Diversity statement including religious language and inclusive frame: - CHS student life, clubs, and family-engagement language:

Element-by-Element Keyword Analysis (grounding the six category scores)

- The six categories have been evaluated above, with keyword inventories mapped to the indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. The overall pattern is a strong lean toward a non-classical, IB/AP-driven framework rather than classical liberal-arts formation.
- For each category, the keyword analysis used two kinds of signals:
 - Keywords/phrases present in Carmel's public materials (e.g., IB Diploma language, AP offerings, counselor and transition-to-college language, Latin as an IB language, etc.).
 - Positive and Negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements lexicon (truth/goodness/beauty; seven liberal arts; great books; Socratic pedagogy; living curriculum; partnership with families; etc.).
- Across all categories, the presence of classical positive keyword indicators is minimal or absent in publicly visible Carmel materials, and there are clear signals of modern college-preparatory and IB structures rather than classical formation.

Citations for keyword evidence - IB Diploma framing and six-discipline spread: - AP/ACP/IB program references: - Counselor/transition-to-college materials: - Diversity and inclusion framing: - Student Life and clubs context (community engagement):

What Would Move the Needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

Not applicable here. The aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL, so no "needle-moving" section is provided as required by the rubric for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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